

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 441

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Lieutenant James Smallwood of the Metro Nashville Police Department.

WHEREAS, our nation was conceived by individuals who were willing to sacrifice their personal concerns to ensure the public's safety and welfare, and the Volunteer State is especially proud to be the home of so many valiant men and women who have performed above and beyond the call of duty in service of public safety; and

WHEREAS, thousands of Tennesseans have continued the time-honored tradition of service in law enforcement, dedicating their time and efforts to aiding those in emergency situations and apprehending those who have broken the law; and

WHEREAS, Lieutenant James Smallwood of the Metro Nashville Police Department is one such courageous law enforcement professional, who has epitomized the highest ideals of public service and contributed greatly to the safety of the citizens of Metro Nashville and Davidson County; and

WHEREAS, graduating from Start High School in Toledo, Ohio, in 2002, Lieutenant Smallwood joined the Metro Nashville Police Department in 2010 and has served in such multifarious roles as the patrol and flex unit as an officer, the criminal investigations unit as a detective, the strategic development division, and in the East precinct as a patrol district sergeant; he currently serves as the lieutenant over the aviation unit; and

WHEREAS, Lieutenant Smallwood is also an esteemed member of the Fraternal Order of Police (FOP), joining in 2010, and as a respected leader among his peers, he served as the Nashville FOP Andrew Jackson Lodge #5 President and Andrew Jackson Police Youth Camp

President from 2016 to 2024, in addition to serving as the National FOP Treasurer from 2016 to the present; and

WHEREAS, putting himself into the service of his fellow officers, Lieutenant Smallwood acted as the volunteer chaplain and peer supporter in the Metro Nashville Police Department's wellness unit and helped to form the next generation of law enforcement as an adjunct instructor with the department's training academy for traffic stop and reality-based training; and

WHEREAS, Lieutenant Smallwood has been nationally recognized for his supernal qualities in policing, serving as a member of President Donald Trump's Commission on Law Enforcement and Administration of Justice, and Governor Bill Lee's 2020 Law Enforcement Task Force; and

WHEREAS, apart from his work as an officer, Lieutenant Smallwood cherishes his beloved wife of twenty years, Cristina, and enjoys as many moments as he can with his children, Cooper and Avery; and

WHEREAS, Lieutenant Smallwood has displayed the spirit and commitment to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud Lieutenant James Smallwood for his dedication to law enforcement and the citizens of this State; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Lieutenant James Smallwood of the Metro Nashville Police Department for his meritorious service to the citizens of Nashville, Davidson County, and the State of Tennessee and extend to him our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.